exactly right: “All these disasters stem from Netanyahu’s indictments.” He, Mandelblit, is the man who started the process of indicting the sitting prime minister, which demanded a lot of courage. Little did he foresee that he was dealing with a wily mafia type ready to burn down his own house to save his skin.

The number of protestors in Tel Aviv (40,000) was not up to that of previous weeks but there were many more demonstrations all over the country. In Tel Aviv, Roni Alsheich said what he was expected to say and, hopefully, it will sink in. Ron Huldai, the long-serving and excellent mayor of Tel Aviv-Jaffa, warned that words would be followed by action. This is what should happen, but what could such action be? Only a general strike could be effective and that depends on the Histadrut (the general labor union). Will the Histadrut move? For some reason, I doubt it: the Histadrut has long since stopped being political. Actually, it is dominated by the Likud.

Sunday, February 5

The current attorney general, Gali Baharav-Miara, shows a lot of courage and steadfastness. It isn’t clear though how far she can delay the oncoming legislation. Thus, the judicial committee of the Knesset started discussing the bill sponsored by the coalition that would establish the authority of Ben-Gvir, as minister of internal security, over the police force. The chief of police would get his orders from the minister, also regarding criminal investigations. In fact, the legislation would turn the minister into the de facto commander of the police: a political commander of the police. A highly dangerous situation.

The president of the State of Israel, Isaac Herzog, a rather wishy-washy politician, appears to understand nonetheless how dangerous the judicial reform is for Israeli democracy. Today he suggested a pause in the process